Bill Gehring

Swannanoa, NC | billgehring@gmail.com | LinkedIn william-gehring

Cognitive scientist and educator with 30+ years fostering academic success for diverse learners. Extensive experience in student coaching, academic-skills workshops, evidence-based learning strategies, and academic innovation. Technological expertise in generative AI tutors and learning analytics. Academic CV available at https://billgehring.com.

EXPERIENCE

Arthur F. Thurnau Professor Emeritus | University of Michigan — 2023–present

Educator and Independent Consultant

- Teach online course "Introduction to Cognitive Psychology" for University of Michigan with enrollments of 30–330
- Develop generative AI tools providing interactive spoken and text tutoring for students
- Conduct quantitative educational research
- Mentor junior academics and evaluate candidates for tenure and promotion

Professor of Psychology | University of Michigan — 1994–2022

Undergraduate Teaching and Student Success

- **Designed and taught "Cognitive Science of Academic Success"** — evidence-based first-year seminar focusing on academic strategies, purpose, and well-being (5.0/5.0 instructor rating)
- **Served diverse learners**: Reserved 50% enrollment for students in Michigan's Comprehensive Studies Program (CSP).
- **Summer Bridge instruction**: Taught in CSP Summer Bridge Program and for Ross Business School Preparation Initiative, both for students from underserved communities
- Developed and taught large-enrollment course, "Introduction to Cognitive Psychology" (300–450 students, 4.9/5.0 instructor rating)
- **Won highest university teaching award**, the Thurnau Professorship, and mentored 25+ graduate teaching assistants
- **Developed and delivered 25+ workshops and presentations on undergraduate academic success** for students, faculty, parents, and high school students
- Advised undergraduates in Brain, Behavior, and Cognitive Science major
- **Coached and advised individual students one-on-one** on study strategies, time management, self-efficacy, and career choices
- Co-taught departmental training course for graduate student instructors

Higher Education Research and Curriculum Development

- **Conducted learning analytics research** using large University of Michigan institutional data warehouse spanning 25 years

- **Led curriculum reform initiatives**: Analyzed Psychology Department 10-year student data and recommended policy improvements to increase student success
- **Chaired high-profile university committees**: Led provost's advisory committee for hiring director of Michigan's renowned Center for Research on Learning and Teaching
- **Advanced inclusive education**: Contributed to CSP Futures Task Force charged with re-envisioning programs for underrepresented students
- **Participated in campus-wide initiatives**: Served on advisory committees for engaged education, digital innovation, and learning analytics
- Used regression discontinuity analysis to evaluate math placement systems and identify changes to increase gender diversity in STEM

Research and Laboratory Leadership

- **Co-discovered the Error-Related Negativity (ERN)** — landmark finding in cognitive neuroscience; seminal paper cited 3800+ times
- Published 75+ research articles and secured multiple federal grants in pediatric psychiatry and educational developmental neuroscience
- Mentored 150+ undergraduate research assistants in a cognitive neuroscience research lab
- Chaired Cognition and Cognitive Neuroscience Area (division of 15 faculty)

Postdoctoral Fellow | UC Davis Center for Neuroscience 1992–1994

- Conducted research on the ERN in individuals with brain injuries

SKILLS

Student Support & Program Development: Teaching and advising college students on using artificial intelligence and cognitive science for academic success • Evaluating curricula and programs using learning analytics and institutional data • Individualized student coaching • Summer bridge and transition curriculum development • Instructor training and development

Research & Analysis: Quantitative educational research and institutional data analysis • Statistical analysis and data visualization in R • Experimental design • Learning analytics • Grant writing and federal proposal development

Technology & Innovation: Generative AI application development • Pedagogical uses of AI • Educational technology • Digital learning tools and platforms

Communication & Leadership: Public speaking and keynote presentations • Faculty development and training • Cross-campus collaboration and leadership • Manuscript writing and peer review

EDUCATION

University of Illinois, Urbana-Champaign — Ph.D., Cognitive and Experimental Psychology
Augustana College — A.B., Psychology, *summa cum laude*, Phi Beta Kappa